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WHEN THE BIG NAMES COME BACK, THE VIJAY HAZARE TROPHY FEELS WHOLE AGAIN

India's senior players, including Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma, return to domestic cricket as the Vijay Hazare Trophy becomes a **key part** of India's preparation for the 2027 ODI World Cup.



Career calibration: Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma will return to domestic cricket in the Vijay Hazare Trophy as they look to remain in contention for the ODI side. K. R. DEEPAK

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The relevance of the Vijay Hazare Trophy, a premier domestic white-ball tournament, has increasingly come under debate. With the popularity of ODIs taking a hit globally amid the dominance of T20 cricket, the domestic competition has struggled to stay in vogue in recent years, as international stars increasingly give it a miss.

That, however, began to change last season. The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) has made it mandatory for all international cricketers to feature in domestic tournaments when not on national duty. This time, as the group stage of the competition gets underway across five cities, two of the biggest names in Indian cricket, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma, will represent their respective domestic teams,